



Notes

Mar 13, 2026

Panasonic Aero - EDA - Service Now

Invited [Bill Venella](#) [Richard Lavin](#) [Justin Rue](#) [Jason Anderson](#) [Raed Soliman](#) [Christine Chung](#) [Matthew White](#) [Rodrigo Magana](#) [Mauricio Da Graca](#)

Attachments [Panasonic Aero - EDA - Service Now](#)

Meeting records [Transcript](#)

Summary

Automation platform utilization centered on an event-driven Service Now integration with license constraint resolution and future summit planning.

Current Automation Platform Setup

The team utilizes an on-prem containerized Automation Platform (AAP) for automation around VMware and F5, actively using Netbox as a source of truth. They detailed their current polling solution for Service Now change requests but prefer an event-driven integration model.

Event-Driven Ansible Integration

The primary objective is transitioning to Event-Driven Ansible (EDA) for asynchronous Service Now notifications, which requires read permissions for a production token and a custom credential type. Integration with Service Now is handled through the ITSM collection across 3 main areas: automating tasks, ingesting CMDB data, and retrieving notifications.

License Constraint and Technology Vision

The team's on-prem AAP faces a license constraint of 100 nodes, which is urgently being addressed with an approved request for an additional 500-node license. The long-term automation vision involves enabling a more DevOps model for system provisioning and configuration using Ansible within their VMware-centric environment.

Details

- **Automation Platform Current Setup and Integrations:** Richard Lavin confirmed the team is running an on-prem containerized setup of the automation platform

(AAP) and is developing automation around VMware networking and custom execution environments. The use of Netbox as a source of truth, alongside Service Now, was confirmed as an active direction, and they are interested in how Ansible can automate other components of Service Now and ingest Configuration Items (CIs) ([00:00:00](#)) ([00:06:37](#)).

- **Service Now Change Request Automation Status:** Mauricio Da Graca detailed their current success in using a playbook to create a change request in Service Now ([00:01:40](#)). The existing temporary solution involves a loop that continuously polls Service Now every five or ten minutes to check if the change has reached the 'implement' state, which signifies all necessary approvals have passed, before running the next playbook ([00:02:39](#)).
- **Desired Service Now Integration Model:** The team prefers a model where Service Now initiates contact with AAP to trigger the subsequent playbook once the change has been implemented, rather than AAP continuously polling the system. Justin Rue clarified that the goal is to achieve an event-driven Ansible integration with Service Now, confirming they have seen a full demonstration of this capability ([00:03:35](#)).
- **Service Now Integration Dependency on Corporate IT:** The PAC folks (Justin Rue and others) confirmed they are in customer-facing operations, distinct from corporate IT, which manages the Service Now implementation. They are seeking guidance on what is needed from the corporate IT department to enable the Service Now event-driven integration, as their Event-Driven Ansible (EDA) components are ready to go ([00:04:24](#)).
- **Vision for Automation and Current Technology Landscape:** In response to Bill Venella's inquiry about their automation vision, Justin Rue shared an overview of their technology environment and automation goals ([00:05:34](#)). The organization is primarily a VMware shop, phasing out Nutanix, and moving toward VMware Aria ([00:06:37](#)). They want to use Ansible to enable a more DevOps model for affecting changes, decommissioning old systems, spinning up new ones, and making configuration changes on the fly ([00:07:59](#)).
- **Netbox and Dynamic Inventory Implementation:** Justin Rue stated that dynamic inventory from VMware and Nutanix has been in use for a while, and they recently implemented the Netbox inventory plugin as an inventory source ([00:07:59](#)). Netbox is viewed as the "source of truth" they are currently working towards, but it is not fully populated yet, requiring efforts to add VM infrastructure details ([00:16:42](#)) ([00:18:30](#)).
- **F5 Automation and Platform Build-Out:** Extensive automation is underway around F5 load balancers using the F5 collection, including adding nodes, VLANs, and route domains ([00:08:57](#)) ([00:12:32](#)). The AAP 2.5 buildout includes Automation Hub, an inventory, and execution environments deployed across three major core sites: New York, LA, and London ([00:10:16](#)).

- Collaborative Use of the Automation Platform:** Mauricio Da Graca emphasized that the automation platform is intended for use by multiple teams, including their team and the ground team for networking purposes, and ideally the SAT team as well ([00:10:16](#)). They confirmed the use of custom execution environments for interacting with F5, Service Now, Netbox, and VMware ([00:11:23](#)).
- Execution Environment Maintenance Strategy:** Raed Soliman provided feedback on execution environment management, noting that they do not need to bake every collection into the execution environment. They explained that using a requirements file allows the controller to pull collections from Automation Hub and bind mount them, which helps manage size and maintainability ([00:14:49](#)).
- Configuration Item (CI) Management Automation:** Raed Soliman highlighted that CI creation should be integrated directly with provisioning and deprovisioning processes using Ansible, rather than relying on separate discovery processes, which often lead to duplication and issues in Service Now ([00:19:13](#)). Since the team is already using the Netbox collection to create entries, this approach aligns with their current efforts ([00:20:52](#)).
- Service Now Integration via ITSM Collection and Three Directions:** Raed Soliman clarified that all Service Now integration activities are managed through the Service Now ITSM collection ([00:20:52](#)). Integration falls into three main areas: using Ansible to automate tasks on Service Now (like creating change requests), ingesting data from the CMDB (via dynamic inventory), and retrieving notifications from Service Now (the direction they are most interested in) ([00:21:54](#)).
- Transition to Event-Driven Ansible (EDA) for Notifications:** The previous Service Now application approach for notifications was limited, so the strategy has shifted to using EDA ([00:30:23](#)). EDA allows automation to be launched asynchronously when an event occurs, solving the issue of continuously polling Service Now for status changes ([00:31:23](#)).
- EDA Implementation and Requirements:** Rulebooks in EDA are always running, waiting for an event, unlike playbooks that run once to completion ([00:37:42](#)). The official Service Now ITSM event source plugin is a scraper that queries a specified Service Now table at a predefined interval, requiring only read permissions for the token ([00:35:41](#)) ([00:43:36](#)). Key needs for this implementation include a Service Now token with appropriate read permissions and a decision environment built with the Service Now collection ([00:42:05](#)).
- Service Now Token and Credential Requirements:** The team has a token for the development environment but needs to ensure the production token has sufficient read permissions for all tables they plan to monitor with EDA ([00:42:05](#)). They also need to create a custom credential type specifically within the automated decisions section of AAP, as these credentials are not shared with the controller side ([00:46:32](#)).

- **License Constraint and Managed Service Goal:** Justin Rue brought up the current limitation of a 100-node license on their on-prem instance, noting that a managed service migration to AWS has been delayed due to legal agreements ([00:50:54](#)). The team is seeking to increase the license count urgently—they have approximately 2,000 VMs, but with Netbox integration, their host count is now over 5,000 ([00:51:51](#)).
- **License Increase and Legal Update:** Bill Venella confirmed that a request for an additional 500-node license has been approved while they await the resolution of legal issues holding up the AWS migration. They expressed commitment to accelerating the resolution of the legal issues, which are currently awaiting sign-off from the customer's contracts team ([00:51:51](#)) ([00:54:24](#)).
- **Future Coordination and Next Steps:** Richard Lavin suggested setting up a bi-weekly touch base for ongoing support and velocity in their automation journey ([00:54:24](#)). Richard Lavin proposed a meeting around the 27th to finalize the scheduling of an on-site visit planned within the next 30 days and address any other pending questions ([00:56:47](#)).
- **Discussion of Red Hat Summit Attendance:** Jason Anderson inquired about the group's interest in Red Hat Summit, noting its value for gathering information on upcoming developments. Justin Rue confirmed their absolute interest, mentioning they had previously discussed it and recently attended a local Summit Connect event, which they found great despite a scheduling conflict. Jason Anderson committed to providing information regarding the summit's schedule and agendas so the team could determine if they wished to pursue attending ([00:57:45](#)).
- **Confirmation of Red Hat Summit Location:** Justin Rue asked for confirmation that the Red Hat Summit this year is in Atlanta, which was verified as correct by Jason Anderson and Richard Lavin ([00:57:45](#)).
- **Scheduling the Next Internal Meeting:** Richard Lavin confirmed that the date for their next internal meeting is set for the 27th. Richard Lavin stated they would invite everyone present on the current call and asked Justin Rue to extend the invitation further if needed. The stated goal of the next meeting is to circle back with good news and ensure the team's success in their automation journey ([00:57:45](#)).

Suggested next steps

Bill Venella will accelerate whatever he can to get the legal stuff for the AWS managed service done by the end of the month.

Bill Venella will coordinate with the team to schedule an on-site visit within the next 30 days.

Richard Lavin will work with the group internally to ensure that Rod, Bill, and Jason are available for the bi-weekly touch base on the 27th.

Raed Soliman will send the group the environment definition file for the Service Now decision environment, a link to his Git repo containing the rule book for Service Now, and the custom credential type definition.

Richard Lavin will set up bi-weekly touch base for the group.

Mauricio Da Graca and Justin Rue will talk with Mike Drifer to get a token for the Service Now dev environment with necessary permissions to monitor the required tables with EDA.

Richard Lavin will invite everybody that's on this call to the event scheduled for the 27th.

Jason Anderson will get some information about Red Hat Summit, including when it is and agendas, for the group to review and see if they want to pursue it.

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Transcript

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00:00:00

Richard Lavin: six running on prem in a containerized setup. Uh and the team has started building you know automation around VMware networking and some integrations using collections and custom execution environments and it sounds like it sounded like Netbox is becoming more important as a source of truth alongside Service Now. Is that a correct statement? Okay.

Justin Rue: Absolutely.

Raed Soliman: So, John, are you guys using EDA or not

Richard Lavin: So,

Justin Rue: So we have EDA components at the ready.

Raed Soliman: yet?

Justin Rue: Um we what we need is to get the service now piece uh connected so that sending events

Raed Soliman: Okay. So just for to guide our conversation today because I think we're we're talking about this uh a couple of days ago internally and and we we wanted like we arrived at the point that we need to check with you folks first on how the direction should go today. Do you want to focus on just the service now and the EDA portion or are you also interested in how anible can automate other components of service now can ingest CIS from service now or are you already past that stage?

00:01:40

Justin Rue: No, I I think we're we're interested in in that. Uh I don't think we're past that at all. Um,

Raed Soliman: Okay,

Mauricio Da Graca: I can give a little chime uh chime in on the latest I don't know if you worked on it Justin after me but the the the How you doing guys? Nice meeting you. Um I work alongside with Justin.

Raed Soliman: let go.

Richard Lavin: Thanks.

Mauricio Da Graca: So, um the I think the last time I worked on the uh on the service now with a bside, I managed to get um the automation going as far as creating a change request coming from uh playbook. The only thing that um I ran issues into because I didn't I think that that project got into the background, but I left it there. It's working. The only problem is that the way that I got it working is that once it reaches to the point of the change request, it creates it, right? And I created a loop that it checks every time that I set up to.

00:02:39

Mauricio Da Graca: It could be every 5 minutes or every 10 minutes. It reaches out to service now to see if the change got into the implement state and then it runs the change request because the implement state means

Raed Soliman: Uh

Mauricio Da Graca: that it got into all the appro it it passed all the approvals required by the

Raed Soliman: yeah.

Mauricio Da Graca: change uh management.

Raed Soliman: Yeah.

Mauricio Da Graca: So um I I know there is another way that Justin was mentioning but as I said that project got into

Raed Soliman: Yeah.

Mauricio Da Graca: kind of like the background of things. We got other priorities at the moment. So,

Raed Soliman: Okay.

Mauricio Da Graca: but I got it working that that whole process works as expected because I did a like a ping test playbook that creates the change request.

Raed Soliman: Okay.

Mauricio Da Graca: I did it on the dev instance of our service. Now, I had the person doing like the quote unquote change management approval and then after that it didn't ping uh playbook towards the server or list of servers that I had on the playbook.

00:03:35

Mauricio Da Graca: The the issue is that we don't want that, right? We want to be able to

create uh different playbooks. One that will be in charge of not reaching out to service now every 5 minutes, 10, 15 minutes. The idea is that service now reaches back and says, "Hey, it's has been implemented. Run the next playbook on the on the line that it will take care of the of the whatever you try to do." Right? So that that's that's the latest of what we have accomplished so far.

Raed Soliman: Yeah.

Mauricio Da Graca: I don't know if you have anything else,

Justin Rue: No, no. I you know I think what you've done is well and good and really really great.

Mauricio Da Graca: Listen,

Justin Rue: Um but we are shooting for the service now um event driven anible integration.

Mauricio Da Graca: correct.

Justin Rue: We've seen a full demo. I want I want to be clear. We've seen the full demo of that uh that um we uh you know

00:04:24

Raed Soliman: Okay.

Justin Rue: including our management and things like that and that's definitely a direction we want to go. Um the pack folks that are on this call, myself and the others, um we're not really in corporate in the or corporate IT IT department. We're more customerf facing operations kind of um you know uh shadow IT if you will you know whatever you want to call it that's our that's our role and so the customer the uh corporate IT department manages the service now um implementation I've actually been talking with a couple people

Raed Soliman: Yeah.

Justin Rue: internally who are doing some of the development on their end I talked to your off I ran into him I was like dude we got

Mauricio Da Graca: Correct.

Justin Rue: to get that going, you know, but um you know, uh that that's kind of where we're at and we need to know what what we need from them to make it happen because from our perspective, the EDA component components are ready to go. Maybe some networking between their environment and ours.

Raed Soliman: Yeah.

00:05:34

Justin Rue: Um you know,

Raed Soliman: Yeah.

Justin Rue: but what else do we need them to do? Is it a do they need is it something that needs to be paid for? Does it you know,

Raed Soliman: Yeah.

Justin Rue: that's kind of where we're at.

Raed Soliman: That's a perfect explanation of the current state. Thank you both so much. Before I start talking, Bill Vanella, you have your hand

Bill Venella: Yeah. Yeah. Hey, hey, thanks guys for making time today. Uh first,

Raed Soliman: up.

Bill Venella: first off, right? Uh you know, as we look to get uh our hands under and and provide more assistance with you. It'd be helpful to understand your vision around automation, right? Uh from a a you know, is it an end-to-end workflow? Are you building playbooks? Uh do you want to get to uh selfservice and uh no human touches? Right. So maybe if you could share uh some background around that, that'll help us steer uh this and future conversations.

00:06:37

Justin Rue: Yeah, I can help with that. And I've I've got uh some slides to share if that's all right.

Bill Venella: Okay. Excellent. Thank you.

Justin Rue: Yeah, no problem. So, um this is kind of what's been Can you see my screen? Yeah. So,

Adam Dein: Yeah.

Justin Rue: this is kind of what this is kind of what's been put forth uh to us from from uh the product owner. Uh um this is kind of what we're going for, right? So, we're pretty much a VMware shop. Um, we have some Nanx, but that's I believe being phased out. We're going all VMware Aria. Um, you know, as much as possible, I suppose. I don't know at all, but like that's that's coming right down the pipe. Um, we have Prometheus agents on all our systems reporting into Graphana. We have Prometheus exporters for F5. Um, we're phasing out Solarance, but we do rely on it still currently. Um and yeah then and then you know Redhead Automation you know we're trying to we I came from tower right we we were we ran Tower for years and so now we're just getting on board with the containerized setup and the execution environments are really nice to be able to develop locally and um and you know push those to you know production basically

with no changes which was nice.

00:07:59

Justin Rue: Um, NEPOX is kind of new, right? Um, in the in the past we've pretty much had all of our info and Solar Winds, right? And, um, we need to get it out of there. And we have, um, Service Now, obviously, but, I don't think everybody's got their head around the entire CSDM model there, right? And, and we had did have some work to put MIDI servers in for Service Now integration to do discovery within our environment, etc. But that's kind of um stalled out as well. So, but from our perspective, you know, we want to be able to affect change. We want to be able to decom old systems. We want to be able to spin up new systems. We want to be able to make configuration changes on the fly. Uh you know, in a more DevOps model without having to handedit anything or anything like that. So, that's where the interest in anible is obviously. So, so you know,

Raed Soliman: Yeah.

Justin Rue: we've been doing um dynamic inventory from VMware and Nanix for a while.

00:08:57

Justin Rue: Um and uh we just recently got the Netbox inventory plugin working as an inventory source as well. So um GitLab obviously um and Netbox and GitLab talk. So um and this is kind of what I was working on. I was kind of working on a I really glombmed on to the Red Hat image builder to get us some rail nodes for the AAP implementation and I really like that and you know I was saw that it you know supports just a web request. Um so you know I I'm like oh you could just wrap a playbook around that even the calling of the of the image builder. And then I went kind of a step further and I started mapping out kind of some of our components, right? So we we have a lot of um F5 load balancers. So those sit at the edge of the network facing the aircraft. Um and traffic comes down to the F5 for various services, DNS, HTTPS, custom ports, whatever you call, whatever you want. And then from the F5, it goes down to our systems, our DNS servers, application servers.

00:10:16

Justin Rue: So, so I've been doing a lot of automation around the F5s. We've been doing uh you know, we've been using the F5 collection to uh to do a lot. This was the AAP25 buildout right here, right? So we we got the automation hub, we got the adventure, we've got execution environments in all three major core sites, New York, LA, and London. Um, so let's let's just go there. Um, so this is the platform right here. So you can see we've got quite a few hosts. This is all the stuff that's coming in from Netbox that really uh jumped up on our host counts um because we've got a lot of devices in Netbox that belong to the stat team. Um so if I go to hosts

Mauricio Da Graca: Yeah, I think I think that's something that you should mention too that it's not going to be only like a tool being used only by us majority. So, it's going to be different teams that probably going to leverage it.

Raed Soliman: Yeah.

Mauricio Da Graca: Two teams if I if I would say uh us and the ground team for networking purposes.

00:11:23

Mauricio Da Graca: Sub.

Justin Rue: Yeah, and ideally the SAT team too, right?

Mauricio Da Graca: Correct.

Justin Rue: Because in the past I have yeah that's where I that's where I really honestly got started with anible was

Raed Soliman: Right.

Justin Rue: on uh they were doing an upgrade for the for the new tech stuff and you know we provided a playbook that saved time on some of the post validation checks for that upgrade and um so we can absolutely you know continue to work with the SAT team as well. Um, so big IPs. So here's some of the modules, some of the things that are coming from Netbox. Um, Maurice has a good point, right? We have SAL authentication enabled, so anybody should be able to get in. Um, let's see. We have custom execution environments. You referenced that. So we have ones where anytime we want to interact with a an F5, we have an execution environment for that. Anytime we want to interact with um Service Now, we have an execution environment for that.

00:12:32

Justin Rue: Neptx VMware, what have you. And you know, I've been talking to the guys about maybe doing a master one where it's kind of got everything that you could possibly need in our environment in one execution environment. you know, we were talking about, you know, how that might affect the size of it and and you know, having to pull it down, but then we were looking at, you know, oh well, you can fix that with a pull policy and things like that. Um, but, uh, as far Oh, um, so job template wise, right, I've been focused a lot on the F5. Um, we really we really,

Raed Soliman: Yeah.

Justin Rue: um, are looking to take ownership of the F5s, clean them up. Um I've we've shown that that a lot of the interaction with E5s absolutely can be extracted. Um so adding nodes VLANs route domain

Mauricio Da Graca: Yeah.

Justin Rue: self IPs we've done all of it. Um and then also fact gathering so that if anybody you know anybody who isn't like m you know

00:13:34

Randeep: Like all the upstream.

Justin Rue: Mr. Mr. F5 they can they can come in here and they can say okay well I'd like to know what the if those F5s are in sync right and run the job against the F5 and get the output right so trying to enable folks uh definitely through a lot of this automation um we also have the um the multi-orbit DNS deployment um which takes it a step further right not just the F5 but it also deploys the nodes um and configures DNS both unbound and bind DNS configurations uh configuration as code checked into git it's all ginga 2 templating um and uh that reminds me see if I can find my net box

Mauricio Da Graca: And uh all of these is tied up to uh git repo by the way we're doing everything on uh git repo basis. So uh companies going cicd so we're trying our best to do everything possible and everything that we can do within anible through uh the git ripple. So trying to get all the teams on board on that as well.

00:14:49

Mauricio Da Graca: work in progress.

Raed Soliman: You guys are doing an awesome

Mauricio Da Graca: We're

Raed Soliman: job.

Justin Rue: Except I can't log

Mauricio Da Graca: try We're try trying our best.

Justin Rue: in.

Mauricio Da Graca: Trying our

Raed Soliman: No, you're your best is very good. Ju just a small comment here.

Mauricio Da Graca: best.

Raed Soliman: Random comment I know not related to the topic but related to the execution environment size thing and maybe we can set up another meeting to talk about that one because I don't want to go down this rabbit hole. But you do know that you don't have to bake every single collection inside the execution environment, right? Like the old mechanism of having a requirements file inside of your git project and having controller pull down that collection from automation hub and bind mounting it to the control to the container as it's running is still a viable option. The only caveat to this is if the collection has a Python prerequisite then that needs to exist in the execution environment selected for that. Right?

00:15:43

Raed Soliman: But otherwise, if if if you're considering like decreasing the amount of execution environments that you have, that that that that's not a bad goal to have, right? Especially as if if if your strategy around maintaining execution environments is that you are the only ones allowed to create execution environments and only the ones that are allowed to update them and manage them. I mean, you have 11, so it's not including the three default ones. So,

Mauricio Da Graca: Mhm.

Raed Soliman: that's not that bad. You're not in a bad spot,

Mauricio Da Graca: H.

Raed Soliman: right? Like I I There's a lot more. There's a lot worse than this. But but there this is also an option for you to just hit the

Mauricio Da Graca: Okay.

Raed Soliman: ones the basic ones with the prerequisites and then rely on requirements. The caveat is the other folks who don't know that they can do that are going to run into

Mauricio Da Graca: Yeah.

Raed Soliman: issues, right?

Mauricio Da Graca: Mhm.

Raed Soliman: So it's it's a trade-off in education versus or in usability or ease of usability versus maintainability I guess right but but but it's a there are

00:16:42

Mauricio Da Graca: Yeah.

Raed Soliman: strategies to handle that if you want to talk about them at some other time

Mauricio Da Graca: Okay. Um,

Raed Soliman: right

Mauricio Da Graca: another thing that I've used it for is that we were doing the population of uh our netbox. Netbox is going to be our source of truth. So basically the the uh execution environments that you saw there for VMware and

Raed Soliman: Okay.

Mauricio Da Graca: Nutanix I use for using the netbox API I use it

Raed Soliman: Yeah. Yeah.

Mauricio Da Graca: for just populating IPs uh autoban IPs primary IPv4s for all the nutanics and VMware host that we have uh in our production environment. So uh basically all the physical components that we have in our core network. I use all the playbooks for nutanics and VMware to retrieve different data names, host names, IPv4s, automand IPs and populate them in the box using net playbooks.

Raed Soliman: So why the API?

Mauricio Da Graca: So uh and sorry the net box selection I apologize.

Raed Soliman: Why not the netbox?

00:17:45

Raed Soliman: Netbox collection.

Mauricio Da Graca: Yeah. Yeah. Sorry. Sorry. Yeah.

Raed Soliman: Oh

Mauricio Da Graca: I use the it took me a time to learn the the syntax and the and the

Raed Soliman: yeah.

Mauricio Da Graca: different keys and it's a very very annoying because uh diff different ones different components within netbox uh have different labels and it's but once you once you get

Raed Soliman: Yeah.

Mauricio Da Graca: the hang of it it's it's pretty easy and pretty pretty useful when it comes to retrieving the data and passing it from one playbook to the

Raed Soliman: Yeah.

Mauricio Da Graca: other super simple very easy.

Raed Soliman: Yeah. Netbox is awesome. Yeah.

Mauricio Da Graca: Yeah.

Raed Soliman: And and and just just the last question before we actually get to talk about the service now part which is you want I'm just curious if Netbox is your source of truth,

Mauricio Da Graca: Yeah.

Raed Soliman: what's the point of discovery?

Mauricio Da Graca: Um, no. No. Right.

Raed Soliman: Like why are you doing now discovery if you're insist

00:18:30

Mauricio Da Graca: Let me let me get back.

Adam Dein: Well, it's going to be the source source of truth.

Mauricio Da Graca: Exactly. Yeah. Yeah.

Adam Dein: It wasn't the source of truth beforehand.

Mauricio Da Graca: Yes.

Adam Dein: And starting with a blank slate,

Mauricio Da Graca: Correct.

Adam Dein: we had to populate it somehow.

Mauricio Da Graca: We We are getting to that point.

Raed Soliman: Okay.

Mauricio Da Graca: Thank you, Adam. Yeah. I I should have I should have rephrased it better. Uh it's not currently the source of truth.

Raed Soliman: Okay.

Mauricio Da Graca: We're getting to that point. We're trying to get to that point of having the source of truth. Right now, we don't even have the VM infrastructure inside uh Netbox. We only have our physical devices on our on our infrastructure. We haven't even gotten to the point of adding VMs into there.

Raed Soliman: Yeah.

Mauricio Da Graca: So, um it's not yet there,

Raed Soliman: Okay.

Mauricio Da Graca: but we're trying to get there.

00:19:13

Raed Soliman: Okay. That makes sense. The reason I was asking is a part of the conversation we usually have with our customers around the ancestration is a lot of them will go down the route of discovery and then run to put it in a politically correct way, run into issues, right? Where where where there's a lot of duplicates on the Service Now side.

Mauricio Da Graca: No.

Raed Soliman: They don't know what to say.

Mauricio Da Graca: M yes sir.

Raed Soliman: Yeah. So,

Justin Rue: Oh. Oh. Oh. We saw that.

Raed Soliman: what what

Justin Rue: We saw that for sure. We did. We did the discovery. Yeah, we we were there.

Raed Soliman: okay okay okay see I was trying to dance around the topic but you went straight there. What one thing that we can talk about and I don't know if that's an interest for you in today's conversation we can definitely touch on it at least is just like how Mauricio automated the creation of change requests from AAP.

00:19:56

Raed Soliman: Something that we can do is we can automate the creation of the CIS on the service now side using the exact same anvil collection. Right? the the the the the big one of the big pitfalls that people fall into is they try and separate the process of CI management from the process of provisioning and deprovisioning and it doesn't make any sense right a CI is a reference to a an asset that you created whether that's a physical asset as a virtual asset whatever it is if you are provisioning it with in an automated way whether that's anible terform it doesn't really matter I don't care how you're doing it you can still call an Ansible job to go and create the CI for Same thing when you deprovision it, you can still call a playbook to go and remove the CI for it. Right? So what happens when you associate the CI management side of it on the service now or netbox or anything with the provisioning and deprovisioning is that you organically manage your CND. You no longer have to rely on things like discovery and fix it up.

00:20:52

Raed Soliman: Right? So we regularly talk to customers about that side to help them fix or clean up some of the issues that they're running into with discovery. But if you're going down the netbox route and it sounds like Mauricio already said that you're using the collection to create things on there, so you already know that, right? Um, okay. Let's I'm I'm going to skip a bunch of things because you folks are already quite ahead of a lot of the parts. So I'm going to go straight to answer the questions that were given to us, which is you don't manage the Service Now side. How do you actually uh or talk to service now for the EDA side of the house? What do you need for them? The messaging from the anible side has changed uh from a year ago. So if you have heard something a year ago, we've changed our approach and I'll explain exactly why we changed our approach, right? But basically everything we do with regards to service now happens through the service now ITSM connection.

00:21:54

Raed Soliman: Right? This is what you're using I'm assuming to create the change requests. What the service now or basically our integration with with service now is in three directions

Mauricio Da Graca: Correct.

Raed Soliman: right or three main buckets so to speak. The first one is using anible to automate things on service now. This is what you're doing when you're creating the change request, right? The second thing is ingesting from service now on the CMDB side. This is just a dynamic inventory plug-in like what you're doing. But it's not good if the data in service now is not good. Let's put it this way, right? Because even though you can filter out a lot of things at the end of the day, it's getting that information from somewhere. So if it's missing or if it's incomplete and you're it sounds like you're already going down the netbox route, I'll I'll talk about point number two, but I'll keep it to a minimum. And the third one is what you're mainly interested in in automating service now and in retrieving notifications from service now.

00:22:52

Raed Soliman: So right so everything happens through that collection. So the first one go

Bill Venella: Ryan Ryan Justin has a

Raed Soliman: ahead.

Bill Venella: question.

Justin Rue: I think we I think we may be on the uh CSM's uh we're in

Raed Soliman: I'm sorry. Say that again.

Justin Rue: the CSM side of service now. It's a weird I'm getting an echo.

Raed Soliman: I I'm sorry. I I don't I don't

Mauricio Da Graca: on the CSM. I don't know,

Raed Soliman: understand.

Mauricio Da Graca: Justin.

Justin Rue: Yeah.

Mauricio Da Graca: I I know I'm using it for the collection.

Justin Rue: Can you can you hear me now?

Raed Soliman: Oh.

Justin Rue: Can you hear me now? Okay. So, yeah,

Mauricio Da Graca: Yeah, we can hear you

Justin Rue: there's an ITSM there's the ITSM side of Service Now, and then there's the CSM,

Mauricio Da Graca: now.

Justin Rue: the customer service

Raed Soliman: Yeah, it it's it's the name of the collection like the the the platform the entirety of it we call it the uh

00:23:42

Justin Rue: and

Raed Soliman: servicem but all the modules are included in so even if you don't

Justin Rue: Okay. So, Okay.

Raed Soliman: yeah

Justin Rue: So, you can still interact with like CSM side of service now just still the ITSM collection.

Mauricio Da Graca: Yeah.

Raed Soliman: yeah that's it's just naming I

Justin Rue: T it. Okay.

Raed Soliman: guess that's what they did so right so you you you could use that to do things like create incidents, create problems, create change requests, create configuration items. The the there's a bunch of modules there that will help you create the most commonly created things that customers would want to create, right? Uh but at the end of the day, Service Now behind the scenes is what? It's just one big gigantic relational database. So even if there is no native module to do the work that you want to do on the service now side like for example if you want to go down the route of automating the maintenance schedules on service now I don't know if that's something you'll ever do considering which side you're on the even there is no native module for it however we still have a way to do it right so um for example if you want to create an incident there's a native module for it looks like any other anvil module and and and you just pass in values to the parameters and do it right.

00:24:59

Raed Soliman: Same thing for problems, same thing for associating instance with problems, uh change requests, like you know all that. What I want to talk about or what I want to highlight again is the API and the API info modules because if you ever get to a point where you want to automate something on the Service Now side and you can't do it through the native module, know that you can still do it with anible through that through the API and the API info modules, right? The main difference is you have to understand what the relation is that you're editing on the service now side. So this is the only time where you will need someone from the service now team to come in and tell you yeah this is the resource that you need or at least give you access to like they have a schema browser so that you can at least figure it out. It's painful to use to be honest but but but it it it will help a lot if you have someone from there to help you.

00:25:49

Raed Soliman: Right. Automating things on Service Now is not different than automating things on F5. It's not different than automating things on on on on on Linux or Windows. It's exactly the same thing. Find the module, pass values to the parameters and you're golden and you're it sounds like you're already doing that, right? So the value of it though or the main thing that I always try to explain to customers is in don't look at automating service now task as an individual step look at it as in terms of like a workflow this is kind of where Bill was asking what's your overall vision I guess right so

don't look at oh I need to create a change request and then do this and then do that no just consider creating change requests and updating change requests and closing change requests as a part of your normal workflows and include them into any anible workflow that you have. Right? So the way to do that is simply just parameterize the playbook to a point and make and pass in the values to the variables by allowing extra bars on that job template or creating a survey and then passing in those values from either previous steps or from an external source.

00:27:02

Raed Soliman: Right? So that way you include Service Now in every single workflow that should have Service Now on it. Whether that's with regards to change requests, if you're provisioning, whether that's regards to CI management like we were talking, or whether that's on the failure branches of Service Now on on workflows, I'm sorry. If you need to go and create an incident or open up a new problem or something, you can do that as well. Right? So that's pretty straightforward. The CMDB side, again, very straightforward. It's a dynamic inventory plugin. In that same collection, you configure it just like any dynamic inventory plugin. Tell it what columns it needs to retrieve, where's your sum of the variables are stored in those columns, and you have a dynamic inventory plugin. Very straightforward. What you folks are mostly interested in is the service now to automation platform direction. right now there people want to integrate service now and uh and and AAP uh from that direction for a couple of ways number one they want to use AAP as the backend execution engine for service now catalog items I don't know if that's something that you folks do or not but let's say somebody wants to go in and request a new server on VMware you can give them a nice catalog item on the service now side they go click click and

00:28:22

Raed Soliman: anible will do the provisioning for them and then do everything else. That's always been the the the the number one use case for a very long time. And for that one, there's a lot of different solutions or there were a lot of different solutions, right? Like there were out always you could configure outbound REST calls from Service Now side to hit like a job launch API endpoint on AAP. That was a thing all the way back from the tower days, right? There's something on the service now site called anible spoke that required a certain tier of service now the ones that had integration hub. This

is not like a red hat official thing but but but but it works. It's basically again it's a nice wrapper around an outbound rest call but simp we we we understand that this is a need and we wanted a way to capture this natively on the anible side in addition to getting notified when certain events happen on the service now side. Right? So a good example of this is the use case that Mauricio gave us.

00:29:20

Raed Soliman: He he kept on querying service now to see when the status of a change request changed so that he can actually take an action and that's not ideal because you're either quering it too frequently and at that point you're a like getting more information from the API than meet or making more API requests than you need to uh and b possibly you're making that query window a little bit larger than it needs to. So that means that there is a delta between when the requ when the change request actually goes through the approval process and when you actually start doing the work on the anible side right. So our solution for this is to get notified from the service now side whether when we need to take an action automatically when a problem is created whether we need to take an action automatically when a new catalog item is requested or approved in your case right when a change request has been created for. So a while ago, I don't know if you've seen the messaging in the two days, there was like an application that you could install from the Service Now side.

00:30:23

Raed Soliman: That was a good starting step, but it was limiting because it had limited amounts of configuration, and it only allowed us to monitor three things, problems, incidents, and catalog requests. Right? Instead, we changed that process to rely on EDA, right? I'm assuming everybody here is familiar with what EDA is and what EDA offers you. Is that correct or am I making an

Justin Rue: No,

Raed Soliman: incorrect?

Justin Rue: no. I I I'm aware of it. I don't know if everybody else

Raed Soliman: Okay. So,

Mauricio Da Graca: I am aware of it too.

Raed Soliman: let's spend a couple minutes talking.

Mauricio Da Graca: Yeah.

Raed Soliman: You're aware too. Okay.

Mauricio Da Graca: Yeah.

Raed Soliman: Maybe it's easier to ask this. Is anybody here not aware of EDA? Should we spend a couple of minutes talking about EDA?

Adam Dein: I think we're okay.

Justin Rue: Briefly.

Raed Soliman: Okay, I think everybody's okay. Briefly speaking, the idea of EDA is to simply um Anible has always been a push, right?

00:31:23

Raed Soliman: You like playbooks. You execute them against your target host. The playbook runs once it's done and you're good. You always knew, however, when that playbook was going to run, right? like you always triggered it uh on purpose or you made an API call to call it or you scheduled it or something like that. The idea of EDA came from the fact that we needed to complete the picture of automation, right? We needed a way for you to launch automation when you need to do so as synchronously when you don't know exactly when the event is happening. Exactly like Mauricio was describing, right? You don't know when all the approvals have gone through on the on the request and you want to run automation when that's happening, right? So how do we do that in an anible native way? We understand that you could always like integrate it integrate another tool to make an API call to AP to launch a job when that happens. But we wanted to do it in an anible native way.

00:32:13

Raed Soliman: So this is where EDA comes from, right? In EDA you write things called rule books. And a rule book is something that runs in a cycle. Think of it this way. It's not like a playbook. It doesn't run to completion and it's done. It keeps running until you stop it or something in there stops it, right? And what it does in that is it goes through a an observe evaluate response cycle. It's observing waiting for an event to come in. When an event does come in, it actually goes in and evaluates that event against a set of rules that you have codified in that rule book. If it doesn't find a match, it discards it. If it finds a match, then it's going to take the actions that you have defined. Actions can be a bunch of things, but realistically speaking, most most folks are going to take actions in the form of either running a job template or running a workflow template, right? And a

job template and a workflow template can do anything and everything can, right?

00:33:08

Raed Soliman: So, the sky is the limit technically with EDA, right? Now, it's very very very flexible in terms of the sources you can work with. Even if there's a source you have in your environment that isn't in this list, that doesn't mean you cannot integrate it with EDA. There are what I would consider generic event source plugins that can work for anything. Like for example, there's a web hook that basically sets up a listener on a specific port. So anything that you have that can make an API call and put like a a payload uh in in JSON in the body of that request can be integrated with EDA. Right now things work or plug uh EDA uh connects to things using using event source plugins. They're no different than any other type of anible content in terms of their packaging and consumption. So they are a part of the service now ITSM collection right the main difference is rulebooks don't do not run in decision in execution environments. They run in things called decision environments.

00:34:10

Raed Soliman: So that's the first thing you're going to need. A decision environment is exactly the same as an execution environment. The only difference is inside that image instead inside of that container. Instead of having anible-core there's anible- rule book, right? And then of course all the other collections that it needs. So you have a bunch of decision environments that come that came with the platform. You can use one of them as the base. You use the minimal as a base and use adsible builder to include that uh service now collection in it and you're good to go. Right. So that's the first thing you're going to need. Now plugins work a little in different ways or like the easiest way to describe this without going down that rabbit hole is there are three paradigms for event source plugins. There is a uh web hook plugin. There's a listener plugin, right? One that just listens and waits for information to hit it. there is a ser like the uh a subscription or a bus a service bus uh uh paradigm in which it subscribes to like think consider think of it as a Kafka topic right or SQS or something like that where it listens on a topic and consumes messages that get written on it and then there's the third type of uh event source plugins which are scraper plugins scraper plugins reach out uh every x seconds where x is predefined interval to query something and get information back.

00:35:41

Raed Soliman: Right? The service now idsm uh records event source plugin the one that we officially have is the third type. It's a scraper. So what it takes from you in configuration is the table it's listening for. So let's say for example in your case like exact the exact same use case you were saying is requests, right? you want to listen to requests and see when uh it's approved, right? So this is the exact same condition I have here, right? So you're looking for the SC requests table and then you're checking that the event.approval is approved and that's when you know that this condition has been met and in that case you're going to run the action of running this job. Right now you can have multiple sources defined in a rulebook. So with a single rule book pointing to service now you can actually monitor uh the uh requests table for the for your change request stuff you can monitor the incidents table to take automated actions when a new incident gets created and you can monitor the problems table to get uh notified when a new problem gets or to have this fetch information about problems.

00:36:48

Mauricio Da Graca: I have one question.

Raed Soliman: Yeah.

Mauricio Da Graca: Can I can I ask you something real quick since this is the topic?

Raed Soliman: Please,

Mauricio Da Graca: So yeah,

Raed Soliman: please.

Mauricio Da Graca: so I understand that the way that I was doing it uh the the job will continue running, right? My job will continue continuously running,

Raed Soliman: Yeah.

Mauricio Da Graca: reaching out, reaching out, reaching out. What this one means is that in a job in a a workflow template of multiple playbooks run separate, right? One dependent of each other. Let's say that there's a playbook that I run for the creation of that change request. This one is not constantly running. This is just a separate job that Yeah, try to explain that to me because I I don't know. Are they is it running constantly or it's just like reaching out with the interval of time

Raed Soliman: Yeah.

Mauricio Da Graca: that you set it to and then after knowing that okay, I got what I

needed which is the approval.

00:37:42

Mauricio Da Graca: Now I'm going to actually run the the the playbook or

Raed Soliman: Awesome. That's okay.

Mauricio Da Graca: whatever.

Raed Soliman: So we have to separate playbook from rule book, right?

Mauricio Da Graca: Okay. Okay.

Raed Soliman: The way your flow happens now is you have a playbook and it just keeps running until it tries,

Mauricio Da Graca: Yes sir.

Raed Soliman: right?

Mauricio Da Graca: Correct.

Raed Soliman: What you're going to rule books run like look for example,

Mauricio Da Graca: Yeah.

Raed Soliman: can you see my AAP environment by the way?

Mauricio Da Graca: Yes, I can.

Raed Soliman: Okay. So what I have on the screen right now,

Mauricio Da Graca: Yeah.

Raed Soliman: I'm in the decisions part and I have my rulebook activations show. This is the service now one.

Mauricio Da Graca: Okay.

Raed Soliman: You can see here the status of it. It's running.

Mauricio Da Graca: Yes.

Raed Soliman: It's going to it's running to infinity and beyond until I stop it, right? So, this is always listening. Rule books run all the time.

00:38:24

Raed Soliman: They're not like playbook,

Mauricio Da Graca: Okay.

Raed Soliman: right?

Mauricio Da Graca: I I never use rule books.

Raed Soliman: You're going to Yeah,

Mauricio Da Graca: So, okay.

Raed Soliman: your playbook though is going to have to be split in half in two different portions. Think about it this or your workflow going to be split.

Mauricio Da Graca: Yeah.

Raed Soliman: The first one is going to go until the part that creates the change request. Then it's going to end. It's done its work.

Mauricio Da Graca: And that's and that workflow completes there.

Raed Soliman: that works for a complete step.

Mauricio Da Graca: Gotcha. Okay.

Raed Soliman: People are going to go and do like go to lunch, go over the weekend, travel for summer, come back, approve the change request. Once that's approved, this rule book is going to pick it up and then it will trigger the second half of the work,

Mauricio Da Graca: Got it.

Raed Soliman: right?

Mauricio Da Graca: Okay. Okay.

Raed Soliman: So like for example,

Mauricio Da Graca: Makes sense.

00:39:02

Raed Soliman: right now if you look at my jobs, I have nothing running, right?

Mauricio Da Graca: Gotcha.

Raed Soliman: If I go into service now,

Mauricio Da Graca: Yeah.

Raed Soliman: of course I have to log in again. Give me a second.

Mauricio Da Graca: Yeah. What was happening for me is that on that jobs page it was that constant running for whatever interval

Raed Soliman: Yeah.

Mauricio Da Graca: I will put for the for the change request to be until the change request was approved. Right.

Raed Soliman: Yeah. No. So,

Mauricio Da Graca: So

Raed Soliman: I'll show you exactly what this does, right? So, like right now I have nothing running, right? If I go in right now and let's say I'm I'm going to request a

Mauricio Da Graca: yeah.

Raed Soliman: uh new let's let's do Azure. Okay. Uh let's call it uhic and let's create two instances red n sure right I'm not going to change anything else and order. Okay, now I have a rulebook activation here. It's running all the time.

00:39:54

Raed Soliman: So once I hit order, it's go. You see what happened right now? It kicked off a job automatically.

Mauricio Da Graca: Yes.

Raed Soliman: So the rule book picked up the event and then kicked off a job on the anible side. This job is now querying service now getting some information about that request because the way service now stores like variables and requests is a little bit weird.

Mauricio Da Graca: That's the

Raed Soliman: they're stored in a different table. They're not stored in the requests table. So, I'm just getting the values for it and then I'm passing them back into EDA, right, as another event.

Mauricio Da Graca: Correct.

Raed Soliman: Now, EDA is going to trigger another workflow. You see what happened here to provision, right? Now, this workflow can do everything. So, this now goes on on service now to create the change request. So, if I go now, this created the change request. I can go and take this change request number and I'll go query it in service now and it will have all the parameters that I passed right and then it's just going to keep it it it exited there and then now it's going down the flow right like it's using terraform to provision then it's going to go and and request the inventory source

00:40:49

Mauricio Da Graca: Gotcha.

Raed Soliman: from service now and then it's going to go like create the CIS configure install data dog do all that stuff and at the very end it's going to either uh uh close the service uh close the change request as a success if everything succeeds or if it fails it's going to go and deprovision the resources do delete the CI blah blah blah and then it's going to open an incident and close it as a failure right so the rulebook is always running the playbook is the thing or the workflow is the thing that only gets run when invoked by the uh rule book if that makes sense right so the

Mauricio Da Graca: Got it.

Raed Soliman: only thing You will need a while ago if you had asked me what like go going back to the question that uh Justin asked at the very beginning what do we need

from the service now side right a while ago you would have needed the service now folks to go and install an application for you to configure that notification and blah blah now the only thing you'll need from them is a token that you can use to authenticate to service now which I'm assuming you already have exactly

00:42:05

Mauricio Da Graca: Yeah, we have that. We have it for the dev environment. We need to get that once we prove the well we have once we have the proof of concept, we we can get that pretty easy.

Raed Soliman: Okay. What what the use the use the token you have now just make sure it has permission to the tables that you want to monitor with EDA.

Mauricio Da Graca: Got it. Got

Raed Soliman: I don't know what right because if if you if if for example you you told them hey I only need to

Mauricio Da Graca: it.

Raed Soliman: automate uh change requests and you want to monitor incidents in the future and they haven't given you permission right

Mauricio Da Graca: Yeah, that token needs to have that permission assigned to it. Yeah, I ran into that problem because I was trying to cancel change requests and I didn't have the permissions to it.

Raed Soliman: exactly

Mauricio Da Graca: I only had the permissions to approve, create, and modify. I didn't have the permissions to cancel it.

00:42:50

Mauricio Da Graca: So, makes sense.

Raed Soliman: yeah everything on the EDA is a read permission,

Mauricio Da Graca: Makes sense.

Raed Soliman: right? Everything on the Ansible playbook side is going to depend like if you're automating and creating,

Mauricio Da Graca: Awesome.

Raed Soliman: then you're going to need either write or delete or whatever. But from the eBay side, if they get a little bit iffy with the permissions, tell them I just need read because I am monitoring it, right? So that's the first thing that you will need. The second

thing you will need to create the decision environment.

Mauricio Da Graca: Okay,

Raed Soliman: Use an builder. I'm more than happy to email you my definition file after this for the decision environment for service now. That's going to make things easier for you. Actually,

Mauricio Da Graca: please.

Raed Soliman: I'll I'll Yeah.

Mauricio Da Graca: Yeah. Yeah.

Raed Soliman: Uh and then the third thing you need is the rule book for Service Now, right? Uh I have I can send you a link to my Git repo.

00:43:36

Raed Soliman: It has that like uh Can you still see my screen?

Mauricio Da Graca: Yes,

Raed Soliman: Okay. So,

Mauricio Da Graca: we're doing some

Raed Soliman: yeah.

Mauricio Da Graca: plagiarism.

Raed Soliman: Oh, the plagiarize away my friend. That's in in open source. There is no plagiarism, right?

Mauricio Da Graca: That's what I'm saying.

Raed Soliman: And so

Justin Rue: code re code reuse is where it's at.

Raed Soliman: get

Justin Rue: I I had a question. Um um I I had a question. Uh does that have you you you mentioned that

Raed Soliman: Yeah, go ahead.

Justin Rue: they no longer need to install an app and that you're just requiring read access um and a token. Does that indicate that it's really no longer a push from Service Now like out

Raed Soliman: Yeah, it's not it's not it's not. So the old app was being the notification was being pushed from service now to AAP. Now with the event with the new event source plug-in, it's a scraper. So we reach out and query the table on the Service Now side every X seconds.

00:44:29

Justin Rue: Okay.

Raed Soliman: So we need the token to be able to do that, right? So we are the EDA server is going out to EDA. So you're not, in other words, you're not going through your med servers anymore. You're going straight to Service Now.

Mauricio Da Graca: I can help you out,

Raed Soliman: That makes sense.

Mauricio Da Graca: Justin, because I was working with Mike Drifer and he's the one that does everything on development side for Service Now. So, we can get a token anytime next week.

Justin Rue: Yeah,

Mauricio Da Graca: I can we can I can just talk to him on the side and get a

Justin Rue: that that sounds good. And him and and me and Jason Jonas go way back,

Mauricio Da Graca: token.

Justin Rue: so we could definitely team up on that. Um so so but but to that end like it's the same as what Mauricio is doing essentially but just more Anible native right you're still quering your your polling um um service now it's not really that push that can

00:45:24

Raed Soliman: Yeah.

Justin Rue: be you know looking for I guess just and then um my

Raed Soliman: Yeah.

Justin Rue: other question is yeah or not question but my other point is we will have to ensure that uh whatever execution node is running that is going to need is going to be able to reach Service Now, right? Because Service Now runs in the SAS platform. Some sometimes we have systems that are, you know, in a in an isolated network, you know, a lot of times just VPN in only things like that. We we'll work it out,

Raed Soliman: So you have to separate again.

Justin Rue: but we'll work it out. But like I just wanted to mention

Raed Soliman: No, but be careful. You have to separate when you're talking to Service Now to create something on Service Now

Justin Rue: Yeah.

Raed Soliman: versus that event source plugin that's reaching out to Service Now to get the information because that runs on the EDA node. So in your inventory file when you're setting up EAP whatever you put under the EDA group that is what is going to be reaching out to a uh to service now to read it for the rule book right yeah

00:46:32

Justin Rue: Oh, yeah. Yeah, that makes sense. Okay.

Raed Soliman: now uh uh I have two things I wanted to yeah so this is the I'll give you a link to this gate repo it's public this has two things right you don't want the request incident handler you don't want the one that has web hook. This is the old one, right? You want the rule book that has uh the service now ITSM records. They're both under the rulebook directory in your source control repository.

Mauricio Da Graca: Okay.

Raed Soliman: Your rule book needs to live inside a directory called rulebooks. Otherwise, EDA controller will not find it. Okay, so keep that in mind.

Mauricio Da Graca: Okay.

Raed Soliman: This the third and final thing you will need is just like how when you're automating service now from the controller side you had to create a custom credential type for service now

Mauricio Da Graca: Yes.

Raed Soliman: you'll need to do the same thing for under automated decisions. Remember they do not share the infrastructure definitions. Right?

00:47:30

Raed Soliman: So you're going to go under infrastructure credential types.

Mauricio Da Graca: Oh,

Raed Soliman: Right?

Mauricio Da Graca: so the same credential that I have created on the top which is for automated this uh for the

Raed Soliman: They're going

Mauricio Da Graca: for the Yeah.

Raed Soliman: for service now style.

Mauricio Da Graca: Okay.

Raed Soliman: Yes.

Mauricio Da Graca: I I have that credentials still.

Raed Soliman: Right. If you want me to send you mine too,

Mauricio Da Graca: Okay.

Raed Soliman: I'm happy to do

Mauricio Da Graca: Okay. Okay. Yeah, I have those credentials already in the in our AAP.

Raed Soliman: that.

Mauricio Da Graca: So, um all I have to do is just do the same thing.

Raed Soliman: Yeah.

Mauricio Da Graca: Create the credential type and then put the credentials in it and that's it.

Raed Soliman: Yeah. This is my credential type. I I can include that in the email if if this is going to make it

Mauricio Da Graca: I think I'm going in the same route,

Raed Soliman: easy.

Mauricio Da Graca: but just share it just in case because I think I have the same uh input configuration as well as the injector

00:48:07

Raed Soliman: Yeah.

Mauricio Da Graca: configuration.

Raed Soliman: Okay. Perfect.

Mauricio Da Graca: Yeah.

Raed Soliman: And and then like if if if you go down you you'll see that once like once the workflow I don't know what it's still doing data dog of course but it it takes time to install the agents and do all of that. But like if I go back you'll see that it's gone down and done a bunch of things. So, it created already the CIS for the Panasonic VMs, right? Pulled in the public IPs,

Mauricio Da Graca: Nice.

Raed Soliman: created them, did all of that. It's updating like you see, it's updating the the stages for the request that it created and then it's going to close

Mauricio Da Graca: What is the request? Yep.

Raed Soliman: it, right? It's going to do all of those things for you. So, you don't have to manually update anything on the Service Now side anymore.

Mauricio Da Graca: That is

Raed Soliman: Once you include it as a part of your workflow,

Mauricio Da Graca: awesome.

00:48:55

Raed Soliman: you're done. And I'm using this for every single thing I'm doing, right? And the reason I'm doing this is like if you look at this is back to the automation side.

Mauricio Da Graca: Yeah.

Raed Soliman: Now this is not the um the decision side or the EDA side. But everything I have is very generic like when I create an a change request. If I launch this right or actually I can show you this has a survey on it that these values are never hardcoded. These values always gets passed in from any other job. Right? So if I want to time I want to create it like this is a test right

Mauricio Da Graca: Okay.

Raed Soliman: testing for demo and then the priorities and everything else is just passed in from somewhere

Mauricio Da Graca: That's

Raed Soliman: else.

Mauricio Da Graca: it.

Raed Soliman: So if you have it parameterized that way then you can reuse it in every workflow you have and

Mauricio Da Graca: Yeah. And you don't have to manually input it every time you launch a playbook.

00:49:45

Raed Soliman: you don't have to just Exactly. Exactly.

Mauricio Da Graca: You don't need the surveys.

Raed Soliman: Exactly.

Mauricio Da Graca: It's just passing it by.

Raed Soliman: So consider Exactly.

Mauricio Da Graca: Passing it by. Okay. Gotcha.

Raed Soliman: So consider doing that,

Mauricio Da Graca: Yeah.

Raed Soliman: right? Uh in I know I know I rushed through a couple of things here, but just to summarize what I'm going to send you is the environment definition,

Mauricio Da Graca: Awesome.

Raed Soliman: the decision environment definition. I will send you a link to the git repository and I will send you the uh custom credential type definition.

Mauricio Da Graca: Okay.

Raed Soliman: Any other questions on that topic?

Mauricio Da Graca: Not from my side.

Raed Soliman: Perfect. And is there anything we can do from the Red Hat side to in general push your automation further? May make make things happen faster for you, not specifically just to that topic, but to anything AAP in general. Like are you folks familiar with everything that's new in 2.6?

00:50:54

Raed Soliman: Do you know what's coming down the line? Are you uh happy with the way you're managing AAP on prem? Are you considering deploying AAP in a different way? Is there anything we can help you with with regards to

Justin Rue: Yes. Yes. Absolutely. So, first of all,

Raed Soliman: automation?

Justin Rue: the um event source plugin is huge. That sounds like it's going to reduce our dependency on the corporate IT department, which is kind of where we were stuck. Um you know,

Raed Soliman: Exactly.

Justin Rue: so if we all we need it from them is a token, that's fantastic.

Raed Soliman: Yep.

Justin Rue: In regards to Anzible automation platform, we are um currently limited a 100 node license on the on-prem

Raed Soliman: All

Justin Rue: instance. There was an initiative to go to AWS managed and we got held up at the

Richard Lavin: Yeah.

Raed Soliman: right.

Justin Rue: uh legal department actually with the MSA agreements and stuff like that. And so Richard and and everyone I need I need your help with that.

00:51:51

Richard Lavin: Uh, Bill, you want to address

Bill Venella: Yeah. Yeah, guys. Uh so, real quick on that.

Richard Lavin: that?

Bill Venella: Uh so, I just sent a uh an email to Tin and team and and it looks like you've gotten a a PR request approved for an additional 500 while we're waiting for uh the legal

stuff to be worked out. And then an update on the legal side. Uh we I think we're really close. Uh I just responded with updates back to uh your uh contracts team. So hopefully uh we can get this knocked out real really

Justin Rue: Oh yeah. Okay.

Bill Venella: quickly.

Justin Rue: Sorry, wrong mic.

Justin Rue: Yeah. Okay. That that that's great. Thank you very much for that update. And um you know 500 will get us a little bit more capability, but you know we really are looking to unleash the beast here and and go for the for the you know the entire environment when when we can. um you know and I think uh you know and as well as go to manage service you know and reduce the operational overhead there of moni maintaining the platform and stuff like that and uh that would be nice as well and and uh that way we could focus on

00:53:15

Justin Rue: the the job templates the inventories and the real work um

Bill Venella: Yeah. Yeah.

Justin Rue: and and you know we've got at least probably 2,000 VMs and as you saw you know once

Bill Venella: So

Richard Lavin: What?

Justin Rue: know that we're sourcing everything absolutely everything from Netbox. Um, you know, uh, you know, it's it's really getting even more.

Raed Soliman: Yeah.

Justin Rue: So, it's over 5,000 now. So, we probably will have some filtering to do on our end um, from Netox on that. But, uh, we are looking to get that license count increase pronto to really enable our folks like uh, re you I'll give a use case. Rodrigo, for example, is uh last I heard working on a h new service account

Bill Venella: Oh

Justin Rue: for tenable. And so he needs to be able to go out and touch all of our systems and deploy that.

Bill Venella: yeah.

Justin Rue: Um you know, and so um you know, currently the license count limit that we're at would still handcuff us there. Um and uh Anible Navigator has been real, uh helpful in that regard.

00:54:24

Raed Soliman: Okay.

Bill Venella: Good. Well,

Raed Soliman: Awesome.

Bill Venella: I will tell you uh you have my commitment uh to accelerate what whatever I can uh to get this done by the end of uh the month. Right. I think we're just waiting on uh legal from from your end. Right.

Richard Lavin: Yeah, we

Bill Venella: And then uh just a couple other things,

Justin Rue: Okay,

Richard Lavin: made

Bill Venella: right? uh you know I think we have a couple of ideas uh around you know how to create some velocity right uh sounds like you guys have done a lot here uh we have some ideas on helping you through that journey we'd love to share and you know I would say uh we're also looking to schedule an on-site within the next 30 days so we should probably coordinate all of those things together. Um, and you know, we we want to be part of your success here.

Richard Lavin: And thanks, Bill. Justin, one of the things I was thinking is, and we only have about a minute here, is we could set up uh, you know, bi-weekly touch base if that makes sense for you guys.

00:55:34

Richard Lavin: And um you know as as we move forward is would that be something you guys would be interested in

Justin Rue: Yeah, I think it's been helpful.

Richard Lavin: or

Justin Rue: Um, we had with Brad previously and you know, we're gonna, um, you know, I'd like to expand the audience, too. You know, I think I think the more people the marrier and,

Richard Lavin: Yeah.

Justin Rue: um, I was going to ask Ren deep what his thoughts were. um you know and for his edification I talked to Jake previously about you know having a workshop with Red Hat and but not long after we um met with another vendor and uh um and that that workshop went really well and we are looking to just kind of evangelize anible within the envir within the organization more and I could use your help there. So Randy Penny If not, if not, we'll take that offline and and we'll figure out some damage.

Richard Lavin: Yeah. So, what I was thinking, Justin, is maybe if we could look at the 27th. I don't know if this I got to check our internal calendars, but I think by then we're hoping we'll have the legal stuff figured out, right?

00:56:47

Richard Lavin: And then we could have a touch base there to solidify, as Bill was saying, the um the the on-site visit. And any other questions that you guys may have have or come up with, we could address then and we'll address them earlier if you just send it to us. But how does that sound?

Justin Rue: Sounds great.

Richard Lavin: All right. So, I will uh I'll work with our guys internally just to make sure that they're available, Rod and Bill and Jason,

Raed Soliman: So I know we're at time but Justin I'm sorry I have one last question if you don't mind.

Richard Lavin: and we'll look

Raed Soliman: Are you folks the group responsible for maintaining the platform currently?

Justin Rue: Yes.

Mauricio Da Graca: Yes.

Raed Soliman: Okay. All right. uh asking just because when like when the AWS goes through we want to have a conversation about remote execution no provisioning and and how that works. It's done a little bit differently if you want to have remote execution outside of AWS or not right. So um yeah just making sure that you're the group to talk to at that point.

00:57:45

Raed Soliman: So thank you for that.

Justin Rue: Y get them

Raed Soliman: Yep.

Jason Anderson: I sorry I have one last question I got to jump in.

Justin Rue: Yep,

Jason Anderson: Um do you guys have any interest in Red Hat Summit? Um have you ever done that before? Because it's quite valuable. You can pick up a lot of information and what's coming down the road uh from it.

Justin Rue: absolutely. I mean, we've tal I've talked talked about it before. Um I went to the local Summit Connect recently. Um barely made it actually because we had another uh workshop the same day actually, but uh I did uh meet up with some folks up there and it was really great.

Jason Anderson: All

Justin Rue: So, um

Jason Anderson: right. Well,

Justin Rue: Yeah,

Jason Anderson: I I'll get you some information around summit when it is and agendas and you guys can look at it and see if it's something you want to pursue.

Justin Rue: we are in Atlanta this year, right?

Jason Anderson: Correct.

Richard Lavin: Yeah.

Jason Anderson: Yes.

Richard Lavin: So, it looks like we're good for the 27th internally. I'll invite the uh everybody that's on this that's on this call and if you want to Yeah.

Mauricio Da Graca: please. Thank you.

Richard Lavin: And if Yep. And if you want to uh extend that out, Justin, please do.

Mauricio Da Graca: Thank you, Rod. Appreciate it.

Transcription ended after 00:59:46

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